# EL LAZARILLO DE TORMES

# IN EASY SPANISH

PRINTABLE READING COMPANION
B1 study target · Spanish from Spain · Adult learners

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## How to use these worksheets

Read the corresponding Spanish episode first. Then write your response in Spanish if possible. Use the English support translation in the book only after trying independently. These extra prompts follow the 18-episode structure of this edition; they do not replace the book's Answer Key.

## Before reading: My goals and questions

## EPISODE 00 — Prólogo

Why does Lázaro begin with his childhood instead of explaining “el caso” immediately?

## EPISODE 01 — El nombre y el toro

What circumstances lead Lázaro to the blind man? What does he learn at the stone bull?

## EPISODE 02 — Las oraciones y el jarro

How does Lázaro try to drink the wine? Why does the blind man punish him?

## EPISODE 03 — El racimo

What was their agreement about the grapes? How does silence expose the lie?

## EPISODE 04 — La longaniza y el poste

What does Lázaro substitute for the sausage, and why does he decide to leave?

## EPISODE 05 — El pan bajo llave

What does the priest keep in the locked chest? How does this affect the boy?

## EPISODE 06 — La llave y los ratones

Why does the priest believe rodents are stealing bread? What does Lázaro do next?

## EPISODE 07 — El silbido

What causes the whistling sound? How does the priest react?

## EPISODE 08 — Un amo de buena presencia

Which outward details suggest wealth? What is the reality inside the home?

## EPISODE 09 — El criado pone la mesa

How does Lázaro become the provider rather than the one receiving food?

## EPISODE 10 — La casa donde no comen

How does Lázaro describe hunger and uncertainty in the squire’s home?

## EPISODE 11 — La honra y los acreedores

Why do the creditors arrive? What happens when the squire disappears?

## EPISODE 12 — El fraile de la Merced

Why does Lázaro leave the friar? What role does this short chapter play?

## EPISODE 13 — Los regalos y la disputa

How do the apparent conflict and the seller’s tactics influence the audience?

## EPISODE 14 — La iglesia llena

What does the crowd think it witnesses? What evidence changes our interpretation?

## EPISODE 15 — El agua y la ropa

How does Lázaro earn and save money? Why are the new clothes significant?

## EPISODE 16 — Un oficio real

What job does the adult Lázaro obtain? How does it change his public position?

## EPISODE 17 — El caso

Distinguish the gossip about Lázaro’s marriage from what his account confirms.

## AFTER READING

1. Choose a scene in which a character’s public image differs from material reality. What evidence supports your interpretation?

2. What changes between Lázaro’s childhood dependence and his adult public position? Which problems remain?

3. At the end of the story, distinguish reported gossip, direct observation and Lázaro’s own claims.